Hustle Hive CIC – Medical Needs and Medicines Policy

This policy sets out how Hustle Hive CIC supports children, young people and adults with medical conditions, and how we manage medicines safely. It replaces our separate Supporting Participants with Medical Conditions policy and our Medicines Policy and Procedures (HHL-P17).

Item	Detail
Organisation	Hustle Hive CIC, company no. 16691281
Policy lead	Gavin Copland, Director and Designated Safeguarding Lead
Version	2.0
Effective from	October 2026
Next review	September 2027, or sooner after a serious incident, a medication error or a change in guidance

1. Purpose and scope

No one will be excluded from our activities just because they have a medical condition. We will make reasonable adjustments and plan carefully so that people with medical needs can take part safely. We will only decline or limit a place if, after exploring adjustments with the family and any referring school, we cannot meet a person's needs safely.

This policy covers everyone who takes part in Hustle Hive CIC activities: learners in alternative provision, children at holiday clubs and workshops, home-educated learners, and adults on our courses. It applies on our premises, on visits and off-site activities, and during any transport we provide.

Medical conditions include physical conditions such as asthma, allergies and anaphylaxis, diabetes and epilepsy; mental health needs; neurodevelopmental conditions; disabilities; and temporary injuries or illnesses.

Legal and guidance context

Hustle Hive CIC is not a school, but we follow the principles of the Department for Education's guidance *Supporting pupils at school with medical conditions* as good practice. We also act in line with the Health and Safety at Work etc. Act 1974, the Equality Act 2010, the Misuse of Drugs Regulations 2001, *Keeping Children Safe in Education* and UK GDPR. Where a school or local authority places a learner with us, we share responsibility for healthcare planning with them.

2. Responsibilities

Who	Responsibilities
Directors	Make sure this policy is in place, resourced and reviewed
Gavin Copland, policy lead	Collects medical information; writes and reviews Individual Healthcare Plans; oversees medicines storage and records; investigates medication errors; arranges staff training
First aiders	Give first aid and support medical emergencies; keep first aid kits stocked
All staff	Know the medical needs of the learners they work with; follow healthcare plans; give medicines only when trained and authorised; record and report every dose, refusal and incident
Parents and carers	Tell us about medical needs before the first session and whenever they change; provide medicines in date and in original packaging; complete consent forms; collect medicines when needed
Referring schools and local authorities	Share relevant medical information and existing healthcare plans before a placement starts
Learners	Follow their healthcare plan where they are able to; tell staff if they feel unwell; keep any medicine they carry safe

3. Medical information and healthcare plans

Before someone starts

We collect medical information before anyone's first session: through the referral and admission meeting for alternative provision, and through the booking form for holiday clubs, workshops and courses. We ask about the condition, symptoms and triggers, medicines, allergies, emergency actions, any activity restrictions and emergency contacts. Where needed, and with consent, we also speak to health professionals.

If we learn about a significant medical need, the person will not start until a plan is in place, unless it is safe to agree interim arrangements with the parent or carer.

Individual Healthcare Plans

Every learner with a significant or long-term condition, or who needs emergency medicine such as an adrenaline auto-injector, rescue medication for epilepsy or insulin, will have an Individual Healthcare Plan (IHP). Gavin Copland writes it with the parent or carer, the learner where appropriate, the referring school and any health professionals. Where a school already has an IHP, we use it as our starting point.

The IHP sets out the condition, daily needs, signs that the person is becoming unwell, what to do in an emergency, medicines and doses, any activity adjustments, and who is responsible for what. It is reviewed at least once a year, and straight away when needs change or after a medical incident.

Sharing information with staff

Staff are told about the medical needs of everyone they work with before each session. A one-page summary of each IHP, with the emergency actions, is kept with the register and goes on every off-site activity.

Workshop activities

Individual and activity risk assessments take account of medical needs. Examples include photosensitive epilepsy, skin conditions or asthma triggered by inks, heat and fumes, and burns risk for anyone with reduced sensation. We may adjust an activity or ask a person not to take part where the risk cannot be controlled.

4. Medicines

General rules

Wherever possible, medicines should be taken at home, outside our session times. We will only give a medicine during a session when it is needed during that time.

- No medicine is given to a child or young person without written consent from a parent or carer, recorded on our consent form.
- Medicines must be in date, in the original container and, for prescribed medicines, labelled by the pharmacy with the person's name, the dose and instructions.
- We never give a first-ever dose of any medicine, in case of a reaction.
- Only staff who have been trained, and who are named on the learner's IHP or consent form, may give medicines.
- Adults on our courses manage their own medicines, and are asked to tell us about anything staff should know in an emergency.

Prescribed medicines

Prescribed medicines are given exactly as the pharmacy label says. We do not accept medicines that have been taken out of their original container or whose dosage has been changed without written confirmation from a prescriber.

Non-prescribed medicines

We only give non-prescribed medicines, such as paracetamol or antihistamine, with specific written consent for that medicine, and after checking when the last dose was taken. We never give aspirin, or medicine containing aspirin, to anyone under 16 unless it is prescribed by a doctor. We do not keep our own stock of non-prescribed medicines for learners.

Controlled drugs

Some medicines, such as methylphenidate for ADHD, are controlled drugs. We do not accept or store controlled drugs, so they must be given at home, outside our session times.

If a learner needs a controlled drug during a session, Gavin Copland will discuss alternatives with the parent or carer and, where appropriate, the prescriber, such as a longer-acting dose taken before the session.

If a controlled drug is found with a learner or on our premises, staff keep it secure, hand it back to the parent or carer and record what happened.

Storage

Medicines are stored securely, out of reach of learners, and at the temperature the label says. Medicines needing refrigeration are kept in a sealed, labelled box on a separate shelf from food, in a fridge that learners cannot access. A fridge thermometer is checked to make sure the temperature stays between 2°C and 8°C. Emergency medicines are never locked away: inhalers, adrenaline auto-injectors and rescue medicines go with the learner, or stay with the staff member responsible for them, at all times, including on visits.

Giving a medicine

Before giving any medicine, staff check the right person, right medicine, right dose, right time and right route, and that the medicine is in date and consent is in place. Every dose is recorded straight away on the medicines administration record, including the time, dose and name of the staff member. Parents or carers are told the same day.

Learners who carry their own medicine

Where it is agreed in their IHP and safe to do so, learners can carry and take their own emergency medicines, such as inhalers or auto-injectors. Staff know where the medicine is kept and check that it is with the learner at the start of each session and before going off site.

Refusal

We never force anyone to take a medicine. If a learner refuses, staff record it, follow any instructions in the IHP and tell the parent or carer straight away. If the refusal could put the learner at risk, staff follow the emergency procedure.

Medication errors

If a medicine is missed, given twice, given at the wrong time or dose, or given to the wrong person, staff:

1. Make sure the person is safe and seek medical advice, calling NHS 111 or 999 as needed.
2. Tell Gavin Copland and the parent or carer straight away, and the referring school the same day.
3. Record the error on the medication error form.

Gavin Copland reviews every error to find out why it happened and what needs to change.

Holiday clubs and short courses

Parents or carers hand any medicine to a member of staff at drop-off, never to the child, and complete a consent form for that day. Staff hand it back, with a note of any doses given, at collection.

Disposal

Medicines are returned to parents or carers when they are no longer needed, when they go out of date, or at the end of a placement or holiday club. Anything that cannot be returned is taken to a pharmacy for safe disposal and recorded. Before a learner who uses needles, such as insulin pens, starts with us, we obtain a sharps bin. Used needles and auto-injectors go in it, never in general waste.

5. Emergencies and first aid

Medical emergencies

In a medical emergency, staff follow the person's IHP, give emergency medicine if trained to do so, and call 999 without delay if in any doubt. One member of staff stays with the person while another supervises the group. Staff tell the ambulance crew about the condition and any medicine given, and pass on a copy of the IHP. If the person goes to hospital and no parent or carer is present, a member of staff goes with them. Parents or carers and the referring school are contacted as soon as possible.

First aid

At least one qualified first aider is on site whenever learners are present, and one goes on every off-site activity, as set out in our Health & Safety Policy. First aid kits are checked and restocked monthly. Every first aid treatment is recorded, and parents or carers are told the same day. First aid does not replace medical treatment, and staff seek medical advice whenever needed.

6. Off-site activities and transport

The risk assessment for every visit takes account of medical needs. Staff take learners' emergency medicines, IHP summaries, emergency contacts and a first aid kit, and know how to reach the nearest emergency services.

Where we transport learners, staff check that the learner is well enough to travel, that emergency medicines are within reach during the journey, and that the driver knows what to do in an emergency. We may decline to transport a learner if it cannot be done safely.

7. Mental health needs

We treat mental health needs as medical needs. Support may include flexible engagement, breaks, a quiet space, reduced demands during distress, and regular contact with parents, carers and referring schools. Any concern about self-harm or risk of harm is handled straight away under our Safeguarding policy.

8. Infectious illness

People should not attend while they have an infectious illness that could put others at risk. We follow the UK Health Security Agency's guidance on how long to stay away, and ask families to tell us about relevant illnesses. Anyone who becomes unwell during a session is kept comfortable and supervised away from the group until they are collected.

9. Training

All staff learn about this policy during induction. Staff who give medicines are trained in safe administration and record-keeping. Staff working with a learner who has a specific condition, such as anaphylaxis, epilepsy or diabetes, receive condition-specific training before working with them, including how to use any emergency medicine. Training is recorded on our training matrix and refreshed at least every year, or as a health professional advises.

10. Confidentiality and records

Medical information is sensitive personal data. It is kept securely, in line with UK GDPR and our Data Protection policy, and shared only with people who need it to keep the person safe. We keep the following records, in line with our Records Retention policy:

- Individual Healthcare Plans;
- parental consent forms;
- the medicines administration record;
- the medicines receipt, return and disposal log;
- medication error forms; and
- first aid and accident records.

11. Monitoring and review

Gavin Copland checks the medicines records every month, and reviews all medication errors and medical incidents to find any patterns. This policy is reviewed every year, and sooner after a serious incident, a medication error or a change in guidance.

Related policies

Read this policy alongside our Health & Safety, Safeguarding, Behaviour, Equality, Diversity & Inclusion, Data Protection and Records Retention policies.

Approval and signatures

This policy has been approved by the Board of Directors of Hustle Hive CIC.

Name	Position	Signature	Date
Gavin Copland	Director and DSL		
Kieron Davis	Director		
Carey Viala	Director		
Sarah Smith	Director		